VENVLEARNING

STUDENT WORKBOOK



Social Studies

GRADE 7

Daily practice, weekly checks, and unit tests

2 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7 Social Studies

STUDENT WORKBOOK

Unit 1 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Unit 2 River Valley Civilizations

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this workbook

Every lesson in your textbook has matching practice pages here. Show your thinking in the work space. When a problem has an answer line, write your final answer there.

- Warm-Up reviews something you already know.
- Practice uses today's lesson.
- Think Deeper problems ask you to explain or find a mistake.
- Exit Ticket shows your teacher what you learned today.

Contents

Early Humans and Mesopotamia 4

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past 5
Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers 9
Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans 12
Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution 13
Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations 17
Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization 20
Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers 21
Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society 25
Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer 28
Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing 29
Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi 32
Unit 1 Review 36
Unit 1 Test 37

River Valley Civilizations 41

Lesson 2.1: Egypt: Gift of the Nile 42
Lesson 2.2: Pharaohs, Pyramids, and the Afterlife 46
Weekly Check 1: Ancient Egypt 50
Lesson 2.3: Egypt and Kush: Trade and Power 51
Lesson 2.4: The Indus Valley Civilization 54

Weekly Check 2: Kush and the Indus Valley 58
Lesson 2.5: Hinduism, Buddhism, and the Maurya Empire 59
Lesson 2.6: China: The Huang He and the Shang Dynasty 62
Weekly Check 3: India's Beliefs and Early China 66
Lesson 2.7: Zhou, Qin, and Han: Confucius, the Great Wall, and the Silk Road 67
Lesson 2.8: Comparing River Valley Civilizations 70
Unit 2 Review 74
Unit 2 Test 75

UNIT 1

Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Historians' tools, early humans, the Agricultural Revolution, the first cities, Sumer, writing, and the first empires and laws.

Your practice pages for Unit 1. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

primary source	Created at the time by a participant.
Agricultural Revolution	The shift to farming.
civilization	A complex society with cities and government.
irrigation	Bringing water to crops.
cuneiform	Sumerian wedge-shaped writing.
empire	Many lands under one ruler.

LESSON 1.1 · PRACTICE
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can distinguish primary and secondary sources, explain how archaeologists learn about the past, and read a BCE/CE timeline.

Standards: C3 D2.His.9.6-8, D2.His.10.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.1 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

1. An object made by people long ago

2. A source made by an eyewitness

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · TIME CAPSULE DETECTIVES

What can objects tell us, and what can't they?

You need: a box of 6–8 everyday objects chosen by your teacher (receipt, toy, coin, photo, tool, food wrapper).

1. Examine each object as if you were an archaeologist in the year 7026. ☐
2. For each, write one inference about the people who used it. ☐
3. Sort the objects into primary sources and secondary sources (if any). ☐
4. Write what these objects can't tell you about the family. ☐

3 Record your results in the table.

Object	What it suggests	Questions it raises

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Write primary or secondary for each source, or answer the question.

4 Primary or secondary: a clay tablet written in 2000 BCE

5 Primary or secondary: a website about ancient Sumer

6 Which is earlier, 2500 BCE or 1800 BCE?

PART D Practice

Directions: Write primary or secondary for each source, or answer the question.

7 Primary or secondary: a diary from 1863

8 Primary or secondary: your history textbook

9 Primary or secondary: a stone tool

10 Order from earliest: 1200 BCE, 3500 BCE, 200 CE, 500 BCE

11 Years from 3000 BCE to 1000 BCE

12 Years from 200 BCE to 300 CE

13 A king's victory monument says he never lost a battle. Why should a historian be careful with this source?

PART E Exit Ticket

14 Name one strength and one limit of using artifacts as evidence.

LESSON 1.2 · PRACTICE
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe how early humans lived as hunter-gatherers and spread across the world.

Standards: C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Geo.6.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.2 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term or its meaning for each item.

1. Old Stone Age

_____

2. A person who moves from place to place

_____

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · WHAT'S IN THE PACK?

What would a nomadic family carry?

You need: paper; pencil.

1. Your band of 25 is moving to its winter camp. Everything must be carried. ☐
2. List the 8 most important items you would take and why. ☐
3. Compare your list with a family member's and agree on a final list. ☐

3 Record your band's final list of 8 items.

Item	Why we need it

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

4 Where did Homo sapiens first appear?

5 Why did hunter-gatherers move often?

6 Name one Paleolithic technology.

PART D Practice

7 Why did groups stay small?

8 What do cave paintings suggest about early people?

9 How did fire change life?

10 Explain why archaeologists know more about Paleolithic tools than Paleolithic clothing.

PART E Exit Ticket

11 Describe one advantage and one challenge of the hunter-gatherer way of life.

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 1.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

Directions: Write primary or secondary for each source, or answer the question.

1. Primary or secondary: a photo taken in 1920

2. Primary or secondary: an encyclopedia article

3. Which is earlier: 1500 BCE or 900 BCE?

4. Years between 300 BCE and 200 CE

5. Where did Homo sapiens first appear?

6. Why did hunter-gatherers move from place to place?

LESSON 1.3 · PRACTICE
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how farming began and how it changed human life.

Standards: C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.3 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term or its meaning for each item.

1. New Stone Age

2. Taming plants and animals

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · GAINS AND LOSSES

Was farming an improvement?

You need: paper.

1. Make a T-chart: Gains | Losses. ☐
2. List at least four of each from the lesson. ☐
3. Decide: for an ordinary person, was life better or worse? Write a claim with two pieces of evidence. ☐

3 Make your T-chart.

Gains	Losses

4 Claim: for an ordinary person, was life better or worse? Give two pieces of evidence.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Where did farming first begin?

6 What is a surplus?

7 Name one problem farming created.

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question about early farming.

8 Two crops first domesticated in the Fertile Crescent

9 A crop first domesticated in Mexico

10 Why did farming lead to settled villages?

11 How did surplus lead to new jobs?

12 Write a claim: Was the Agricultural Revolution good for humans? Support it with two pieces of evidence.

PART E Exit Ticket

13 Why do historians call farming a “revolution” even though it took thousands of years?

LESSON 1.4 · PRACTICE
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can identify the features of a civilization and explain how surplus led to cities.

Standards: C3 D2.His.1.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.4 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

1. A complex society with cities and writing

2. Doing one kind of job

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · VILLAGE TO CITY SIMULATION

How does a surplus change a community?

You need: 20 dried beans (grain); role cards: farmer, potter, priest, guard, trader.

1. Each farmer 'grows' 5 beans per season but needs only 3 to eat. ☐
2. Decide how the 2 extra beans per farmer can support people with other jobs. ☐
3. Add one more job each round as the surplus grows. ☐

3 Record your results in the table.

Round	Farmers	Extra beans	New job added

4 How many non-farmers could your surplus support? What new problems came up?

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Name three features of a civilization.

6 What made specialization possible?

7 How did people enter houses at Çatalhöyük?

PART D Practice

8 Why might a growing town need a government?

9 Why did record keeping develop?

10 Put in order: cities, surplus, farming, specialization

11 Is your community a civilization by the historians' definition? Use three features as evidence.

PART E Exit Ticket

12 Explain the chain from farming to cities.

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 1.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

1. Where did farming first begin?

2. What is a food surplus?

3. Name two features of a civilization.

4. Name an early farming town.

5. Explain how a food surplus led to specialized jobs.

LESSON 1.5 · PRACTICE
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how the geography of Mesopotamia shaped early civilization there.

Standards: C3 D2.Geo.2.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.5 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Map and Analyze, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term for each description.

1. Rich soil left by floods

2. Bringing water to crops

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · IRRIGATION MODEL

How can canals bring water to fields?

You need: a baking pan with soil or sand; a cup of water; a craft stick.

1. Shape a “river” along one side of the pan. ☐
2. Use the stick to carve canals from the river to three “fields.” ☐
3. Pour water into the river at the high end. Where does it go? ☐
4. Add a small dirt bank (levee) and test it again. ☐

3 Sketch your irrigation model. Label the river, canals, and fields.

4 What worked? What would you change?

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 What does “Mesopotamia” mean?

6 Name the two rivers.

7 Why did Mesopotamians build with mud brick?

PART D Map and Analyze

8 Use the map. Which body of water do the Tigris and Euphrates flow into?

The Fertile Crescent



9 In which modern country is most of Mesopotamia?

10 Which city on the map is farthest south?

11 Explain how a geographic challenge led to cooperation and government.

PART E Exit Ticket

12 Were the rivers more helpful or harmful to Mesopotamians? Explain.

LESSON 1.6 · PRACTICE
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe Sumerian city-states, religion, and social classes.

Standards: C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.6 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term for each description.

1. Belief in many gods

_____

2. A city with its own government

_____

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · DESIGN A ZIGGURAT

What did a ziggurat show about Sumerian values?

You need: sugar cubes or building blocks; paper.

1. Build a three-level stepped tower with a shrine on top. ☐
2. Add a ramp or stairway. ☐
3. Write two sentences explaining why the temple was the tallest building in the city. ☐

3 Sketch your ziggurat. Label the temple, stairs, and levels.

4 Explain your design.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Name two Sumerian city-states.

6 What was a ziggurat?

7 Why did city-states fight?

PART D Practice

8 Who was at the top of Sumerian society?

9 Name one right Sumerian women had.

10 Why were scribes respected?

11 What does the location and size of the ziggurat suggest about the role of religion in Sumer?

PART E Exit Ticket

12 Compare a Sumerian city-state with a modern U.S. city.

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 1.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

Directions: Write the name or term for each description.

1. The two rivers of Mesopotamia

2. Bringing water to crops through canals

3. A stepped temple tower

4. Belief in many gods

5. Describe one geographic challenge in Mesopotamia and how people solved it.

LESSON 1.7 · PRACTICE
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how and why writing developed in Sumer and how it changed society.

Standards: C3 D2.His.1.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.7 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term for each description.

1. Tool used to write on clay

2. A long poem about a hero

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · CLAY TABLET SCRIBE

What was it like to write in cuneiform?

You need: air-dry clay or play dough; a craft stick cut to a wedge point or a chopstick.

1. Flatten the clay into a tablet. ☐
2. Press wedge shapes to record a "receipt": 5 sheep and 3 jars of barley (invent symbols). ☐
3. Trade tablets with a partner and try to read each other's record. ☐

3 Record your symbol key.

Symbol I invented	What it means

4 Two problems a scribe would face:

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 What was cuneiform first used for?

6 What does cuneiform mean?

7 Who was Gilgamesh?

PART D Practice

8 About when did writing begin in Sumer?

9 Why did scribes train for years?

10 Name a Sumerian idea we still use.

11 Explain how writing helped governments become more powerful.

PART E Exit Ticket

12 Which Sumerian invention do you think was most important? Defend your choice.

LESSON 1.8 · PRACTICE
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe the first empires and analyze Hammurabi's Code as a primary source.

Standards: C3 D2.Civ.3.6-8, D2.His.10.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 1.8 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Analyze the Source, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the term for each description.

1. Many lands ruled by one government

2. A tall carved stone slab

PART B

Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · FAIR OR UNFAIR?

Do these laws match our ideas of justice?

You need: the source excerpt; highlighters.

1. Highlight each punishment. ☐
2. Rate each law from 1 (very unfair) to 5 (very fair) by today's standards. ☐
3. Find one idea in the code that is similar to modern law (for example, builders responsible for safe buildings). ☐

3 Record your results in the table.

Law	Rating (1 = very unfair, 5 = very fair)	Why

4 Compare Hammurabi's Code with modern laws.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Who created the first empire?

6 About when was Hammurabi's Code written?

7 Did the code treat all people equally?

PART D Analyze the Source

First, read this passage. Then answer the questions below it.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Code of Hammurabi

Babylon, about 1754 BCE. Translated by L. W. King (1910). Public domain.

196. If a man put out the eye of another man, his eye shall be put out.

198. If he put out the eye of a freed man, or break the bone of a freed man, he shall pay one gold mina.

199. If he put out the eye of a man's slave, or break the bone of a man's slave, he shall pay one-half of its value.

229. If a builder build a house for some one, and does not construct it properly, and the house which he built fall in and kill its owner, then that builder shall be put to death.

8 What happens to a builder whose house collapses and kills the owner?

9 What is the punishment for putting out a freed man's eye?

10 Why would Hammurabi carve his laws in stone in a public place?

11 Name one way the code is like modern law and one way it is different.

PART E Exit Ticket

12 Why was writing laws down an important step for civilization?

UNIT REVIEW
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 1 Review

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

PART A Vocabulary

Directions: Write what each term means.

1. artifact

2. domestication

3. city-state

4. cuneiform

5. empire

6. surplus

PART B Big ideas

7. Explain how geography, farming, and writing each helped Sumer become a civilization.

UNIT TEST
At the end of the unit
About 45 minutes

Unit 1 Test

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] This test has 20 points.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

PART A · Part A · Historians' tools (1 point each)

Directions: Write primary or secondary for each source, or do what the item asks.

1. Primary or secondary: a clay tablet from Ur

2. Primary or secondary: a documentary about Sumer

3. Order from earliest: 1754 BCE, 3200 BCE, 2334 BCE

4. How many years from 2000 BCE to 1500 BCE?

PART B · Part B · Early humans and farming (1 point each)

5. How did most Paleolithic people get food?

   A farming
   B trading in cities
   C hunting and gathering
   D fishing fleets

6. What is domestication?

7 Name one benefit and one problem of farming.

8 Which came first?

A cities
B food surplus
C writing

PART C Part C · Mesopotamia (1 point each)

9 Use the map. Which labeled city is farthest south, closest to the Persian Gulf?



10 Why did Mesopotamians need irrigation?

11 What was a ziggurat?

12 What was cuneiform first used for?

13 Who created the first empire?

PART D Part D · Primary source (3 points)

First, read this passage. Then answer the questions below it.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Code of Hammurabi

Babylon, about 1754 BCE. Translated by L. W. King (1910). Public domain.

196. If a man put out the eye of another man, his eye shall be put out.

198. If he put out the eye of a freed man, or break the bone of a freed man, he shall pay one gold mina.

199. If he put out the eye of a man's slave, or break the bone of a man's slave, he shall pay one-half of its value.

229. If a builder build a house for some one, and does not construct it properly, and the house which he built fall in and kill its owner, then that builder shall be put to death.

14 Reread the excerpt from Hammurabi's Code. What does it show about justice and social class in Babylon? Use two laws as evidence.

PART E

Part E · Explain (4 points)

15 Explain how the geography of Mesopotamia led to the development of government and laws.

UNIT 2

River Valley Civilizations

Ancient Egypt and Kush, the Indus Valley, Hinduism and Buddhism, and ancient China from the Shang to the Han.

Your practice pages for Unit 2. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

silt	Rich soil left by water.
pharaoh	Egypt's ruler, seen as a god.
cultural diffusion	The spread of ideas.
karma	Actions decide the future.
dynasty	Rulers from one family.
Mandate of Heaven	Heaven's approval to rule.

LESSON 2.1 · PRACTICE
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.1: Egypt: Gift of the Nile

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how the Nile River shaped where and how ancient Egyptians lived.

Standards: C3 D2.Geo.4.6-8, D2.His.1.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.1 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. The yearly Nile flood

_____

2. Rich soil left by water

_____

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · FLOOD MODEL

How did the inundation make farmland?

You need: a long pan or tray; soil; a cup of muddy water; a spoon.

1. Spread dry soil in the tray and press a groove for the river. ☐
2. Slowly pour the muddy water down the groove until it spills over the banks. ☐
3. Let it sit, then pour off the extra water. ☐
4. Look at what is left on the "fields." ☐

3 Sketch your flood model before and after the flood. Label the river, the flood, and the silt.

4 How did flood silt help Egyptian farmers?

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 In which direction does the Nile flow?

6 What did the inundation leave behind?

7 Why is Upper Egypt in the south?

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson, the map, and the chart.

8 What did Egyptians call the desert?

9 What tool lifted water into canals?

10 Name two uses of papyrus.

11 Who traditionally unified Egypt, and about when?

12 Compare the Nile with the Tigris and Euphrates (Unit 1). Give one similarity and one difference.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 Explain why Herodotus called Egypt “the gift of the Nile.” Use two details.

LESSON 2.2 · PRACTICE
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.2: Pharaohs, Pyramids, and the Afterlife

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how Egyptian beliefs about pharaohs and the afterlife shaped their government, art, and buildings.

Standards: C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.2 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. Life after death

_____

2. Egyptian picture writing

_____

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · CARTOUCHE

How did hieroglyphs represent sounds?

You need: paper; pencil and markers; a hieroglyph alphabet chart (print one from a museum website).

1. Draw a long oval with a line at one end: a cartouche, which held a pharaoh's name. ☐
2. Spell your name with the hieroglyph sound chart, from top to bottom. ☐
3. Decorate the border. ☐
4. Trade with a family member and have them decode it. ☐

3 Design your cartouche here.

4 Why did the Rosetta Stone matter?

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Why was Egypt a theocracy?

6 Why did Egyptians make mummies?

7 How did the Rosetta Stone help scholars read hieroglyphics?

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson.

8 What was ma'at?

9 Which god ruled the afterlife?

10 For which pharaoh was the Great Pyramid built?

11 Who decoded hieroglyphics, and when?

12 What does the way the Great Pyramid was built tell us about Egypt's government and economy? Give two details.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 How were religion and government connected in ancient Egypt?

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 2.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Ancient Egypt

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

Directions: Answer each question about ancient Egypt.

1. Direction the Nile flows

2. The yearly Nile flood

3. Egyptian picture writing

4. Artifact that helped decode hieroglyphics

5. Government led by a ruler seen as divine

6. How did the Nile make farming possible in a desert?

LESSON 2.3 · PRACTICE
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.3: Egypt and Kush: Trade and Power

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe how Egypt and Kush influenced each other through trade, conquest, and culture.

Standards: C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Eco.15.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.3 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. The spread of ideas between groups

2. A good sent elsewhere to be sold

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · TRADE MAP

What moved between Egypt and Kush?

You need: a copy of the Nile Valley map; colored pencils.

1. Trace the Nile from Meroë to the delta. ☐
2. Draw arrows for goods moving north (from Kush) and south (from Egypt), using the chart. ☐
3. Label each arrow with two goods. ☐
4. Add a symbol for one idea that spread by cultural diffusion. ☐

3 Draw your trade map. Label Egypt, Kush, the Nile, and the goods that moved each way.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

4 Name two goods Kush traded.

5 Which Kushite king conquered Egypt around 750 BCE?

6 Give an example of cultural diffusion between Egypt and Kush.

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson and the chart.

7 Where was Kush?

8 Where did Hatshepsut send a trade expedition?

9 What was Meroë known for?

10 Which kingdom built more pyramids?

11 How did the relationship between Egypt and Kush change over time? Give two examples.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

12 Why do you think Kush adopted so many Egyptian customs?

LESSON 2.4 · PRACTICE
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.4: The Indus Valley Civilization

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe the planned cities of the Indus Valley and explain what archaeologists still don't know about them.

Standards: C3 D2.His.10.6-8, D2.Geo.2.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.4 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. A seasonal wind that brings heavy rain

2. Made the same everywhere

PART B

Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · PLAN A CITY

Can you design a city as organized as Mohenjo-daro?

You need: graph paper; a pencil and ruler.

1. Draw a grid of streets running north–south and east–west. ☐
2. Add a raised citadel with one public building. ☐
3. Draw homes and a drain line under every street that leads away from the city. ☐
4. Add a market and a granary. ☐

3 Draw your city plan. Include a key.

4 Compare your plan with Mohenjo-daro.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Name two cities of the Indus Valley.

6 Name one sign that Indus cities were planned.

7 Why do historians know less about the Indus Valley than about Egypt?

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson and the map.

8 In which modern countries was the Indus Valley civilization?

9 What carried waste away under the streets?

10 Where have Indus seals been found far from home?

11 About when did the cities decline?

12 What does the use of standardized weights suggest about Indus trade and government? Explain.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 Write one thing historians know about the Indus Valley and one thing they don't. Explain why the second is uncertain.

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 2.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Kush and the Indus Valley

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

Directions: Answer each question about Kush and the Indus Valley.

1. Kingdom south of Egypt in Nubia

2. Kushite city known for iron-making

3. The spread of ideas between groups

4. Two Indus Valley cities

5. A sign of Indus city planning

6. Why is much about the Indus Valley still a mystery?

LESSON 2.5 · PRACTICE
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.5: Hinduism, Buddhism, and the Maurya Empire

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain the main beliefs of Hinduism and Buddhism and how Ashoka spread Buddhist ideas.

Standards: C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.His.4.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.5 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Check Your Understanding, Part C Practice, Part D Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. Belief that the soul is reborn

2. The oldest Hindu texts

PART B Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

3. What is karma?

4 Who became the Buddha?

5 Why did Ashoka become a Buddhist?

PART C Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson and the chart.

6 What does dharma mean?

7 What is the Buddhist goal of freedom from suffering called?

8 What path did the Buddha teach to end suffering?

9 How did Ashoka share his ideas?

10 Name one way Hinduism and Buddhism are alike and one way they differ.

PART D Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

11 How did Ashoka change after the war with Kalinga, and why does it matter?

LESSON 2.6 · PRACTICE
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.6: China: The Huang He and the Shang Dynasty

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how geography shaped early China and describe the achievements of the Shang dynasty.

Standards: C3 D2.Geo.4.6-8, D2.His.1.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.6 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. Fine yellow wind-blown soil

2. Rulers from one family

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · ORACLE BONE QUESTION

How did the Shang record questions for their ancestors?

You need: a paper plate or a piece of cardboard cut like a shell; a pencil.

1. Write a yes-or-no question a Shang king might ask (harvest, weather, war, or a journey). ☐
2. Draw three pictograph characters to stand for key words. ☐
3. Draw crack lines across the “shell.” ☐
4. On the back, explain why the Shang kept these records. ☐

3 Draw your oracle bone and the question carved on it.

4 Explain your question and why a Shang king might ask it.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 Why was the Huang He called “China's Sorrow”?

6 What is a dynasty?

7 What were oracle bones used for?

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson and the map.

8 What does Huang He mean?

9 Name one natural barrier around China.

10 About when did the Shang rule?

11 What metal did Shang artisans cast?

12 How did China's geography make its culture develop differently from Egypt's and Mesopotamia's?

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 Was the Huang He more of a friend or an enemy to early China? Defend your answer with two details.

WEEKLY CHECK
After Lesson 2.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: India's Beliefs and Early China

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

Show what you know

Directions: Answer each question about ancient India and China.

1. Actions decide your future

2. Founder of Buddhism

3. Maurya emperor who spread Buddhism

4. China's first river civilization

5. Shang objects with the oldest Chinese writing

6. Name one way Buddhism was different from Hindu society.

LESSON 2.7 · PRACTICE
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.7: Zhou, Qin, and Han: Confucius, the Great Wall, and the Silk Road

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain the Mandate of Heaven, Confucius's teachings, and the achievements of the Qin and Han dynasties.

Standards: C3 D2.His.2.6-8, D2.Civ.6.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.7 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Check Your Understanding, Part C Primary Source, Part D Practice, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. Respect and duty toward parents

2. Trade routes linking China with the West

PART B Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

3. What is the Mandate of Heaven?

4 What is filial piety?

5 Name one thing Qin Shi Huang standardized.

PART C Primary Source

First, read this passage. Then answer the questions below it.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Analects of Confucius

Sayings of Confucius (551–479 BCE), recorded by his students. Translated by James Legge (1861). Public domain.

The Master said, "He who exercises government by means of his virtue may be compared to the north polar star, which keeps its place and all the stars turn towards it." (2.1)

The Master said, "When you know a thing, to hold that you know it; and when you do not know a thing, to allow that you do not know it; this is knowledge." (2.17)

The Master said, "What you do not want done to yourself, do not do to others." (15.23)

Directions: Reread the excerpt from the Analects in your textbook. Then answer each question.

6 In 2.1, what does Confucius compare a virtuous ruler to?

7 In your own words, what is knowledge according to 2.17?

8 Rewrite 15.23 in your own words. Where have you heard a similar idea?

PART D Practice

Directions: Answer each question. Use the lesson.

9 Which dynasty introduced the Mandate of Heaven?

10 Who called himself the First Emperor?

11 What was buried with the First Emperor?

12 Name one Han invention.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 Choose Confucius or Qin Shi Huang. How did his ideas or actions bring order to China?

LESSON 2.8 · PRACTICE
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: River Valley Civilizations

Lesson 2.8: Comparing River Valley Civilizations

Name _____ Date _____

TODAY'S GOAL

I can compare the first four civilizations and explain what they had in common.

Standards: C3 D2.His.1.6-8, D2.Geo.4.6-8

WHAT TO DO

- [ ] Start with Part A Warm-Up.
- [ ] Read Textbook Lesson 2.8 with your teacher.
- [ ] Then do the rest of these pages in order: Part B Activity Sheet, Part C Check Your Understanding, Part D Compare, Part E Exit Ticket.
- [ ] Answer in complete sentences unless a line asks for one word.
- [ ] Check your work with your teacher and fix any mistakes.

PART A Warm-Up

Directions: Write the word for each description.

1. To find how things are different

_____

2. Something handed down from the past

_____

PART B Activity Sheet

Directions: Gather what you need. Do each step and check it off. Record as you go.

ACTIVITY · MUSEUM EXHIBIT CARD

What is each civilization's greatest legacy?

You need: four index cards; colored pencils.

1. Choose one achievement from each civilization. ☐
2. Draw it on the front of a card. ☐
3. On the back, write the civilization, the achievement, and why it still matters today. ☐
4. Rank your four cards from most to least important and explain your top choice. ☐

3 Record your results in the table.

Civilization	Achievement	Why it still matters	Rank
Mesopotamia			
Egypt			
Indus Valley			
China			

4 Explain your top choice.

PART C Check Your Understanding

Directions: Answer each question.

5 What did all four river valley civilizations have in common?

6 Which civilization's writing has not been deciphered?

7 Whose floods were most regular and predictable?

PART D Compare

Directions: Answer each question. Use the comparison chart.

8 Writing system of Mesopotamia

9 River of China's first civilization

10 Government of Egypt

11 Civilization known for planned grid cities

12 Write a comparison claim about two civilizations. Name a similarity or difference and explain why it matters.

PART E Exit Ticket

Directions: Answer in complete sentences.

13 Why do you think civilizations began in river valleys and not in deserts or mountains?

UNIT REVIEW
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 2 Review

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

PART A Vocabulary

Directions: Write what each word means.

1. silt

2. pharaoh

3. cultural diffusion

4. monsoon

5. dynasty

6. Mandate of Heaven

PART B Big ideas

Directions: Answer in a paragraph.

7. Choose two river valley civilizations. Explain how each river shaped the civilization that grew beside it.

UNIT TEST
At the end of the unit
About 45 minutes

Unit 2 Test

Name _____ Date _____

DIRECTIONS

- [ ] Work on your own. Don't use your textbook unless your teacher says you may.
- [ ] This test has 19 points.
- [ ] Read each passage and question carefully. Answer in complete sentences.
- [ ] When you finish, check that every question has an answer.

PART A · Part A · Egypt and Kush (1 point each)

Directions: Answer each question. For questions with choices, circle the letter of the best answer.

1. Why is Upper Egypt in the south?

2. Why did Egyptians make mummies?

3. Which helped scholars read hieroglyphics?

A the Great Pyramid
B the Rosetta Stone
C oracle bones
D the Code of Hammurabi

4. Name one way Kush and Egypt influenced each other.

PART B · Part B · India (1 point each)

Directions: Answer each question. For questions with choices, circle the letter of the best answer.

5. Name one feature of Indus Valley cities.

6 Which is a Buddhist teaching?

A the Mandate of Heaven
B the Four Noble Truths
C ma'at
D filial piety

7 What is reincarnation?

8 How did Ashoka spread his ideas?

PART C Part C · China (1 point each)

Directions: Answer each question. For questions with choices, circle the letter of the best answer.

9 Use the map. Along which labeled river did the Shang dynasty rule?



10 What did the Mandate of Heaven explain?

11 Name one Han achievement.

12 Who taught that rulers should be fair and children should honor parents?

A Qin Shi Huang
B Laozi
C Confucius
D Ashoka

PART D

Part D · Primary source (3 points)

First, read this passage. Then answer the questions below it.

READING · PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Analects of Confucius

Sayings of Confucius (551–479 BCE), recorded by his students. Translated by James Legge (1861). Public domain.

The Master said, “He who exercises government by means of his virtue may be compared to the north polar star, which keeps its place and all the stars turn towards it.” (2.1)

The Master said, “When you know a thing, to hold that you know it; and when you do not know a thing, to allow that you do not know it; this is knowledge.” (2.17)

The Master said, “What you do not want done to yourself, do not do to others.” (15.23)

Directions: Reread the excerpt. Then answer in a paragraph.

13 Reread the sayings of Confucius. What do they suggest about how Confucius thought people and rulers should behave? Use two sayings as evidence.

PART E Part E · Explain (4 points)

Directions: Write a paragraph. Use details from this unit.

14 Compare two river valley civilizations. Explain one similarity and one difference, and why each matters.

Grade 7 Social Studies

Student Workbook

A full year of Grade 7 social studies. Students read maps, weigh primary and secondary sources, build timelines, and connect geography, history, government, and economics to the people and places that shaped our world.

This Student Workbook holds the daily practice pages for every lesson, plus a Weekly Check at the end of each week, the unit reviews, and the unit tests, with room to show thinking and write complete answers.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

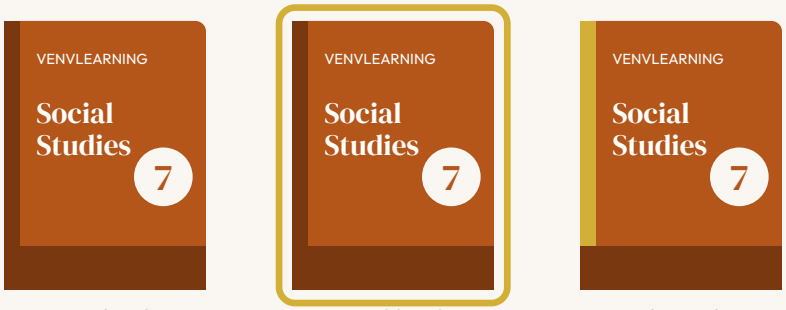
01 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

02 River Valley Civilizations

IN THIS BOOK

- Warm-ups, practice, and exit tickets for every lesson
- A Weekly Check for each week of lessons
- Unit reviews and unit tests
- Space to show work and explain thinking

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook

Workbook

You are holding this book

Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, so the textbook, workbook, and teacher pages always match.